



Amazon University Talent Acquisition (AUTA) Intern Credit Request Policy

This policy is providing relevant information for students who are seeking to use their participation in an Amazon Internship Program for academic credit. AUTA encourage students to maximize their learning during their internship. However, we are unable to accommodate the completion of individual academic forms or agreements relating to academic credit. Exceptions to this policy can be found in Section IV of the policy. Interns may share this policy with their academic institution.

Section I. Role of Amazon as an Internship Employer

As an internship employer, Amazon understands the value of the work that early professionals can add to our organization. Amazon seeks to gain the insightful perspective of current institution students while providing robust experiential opportunities for students to learn and grow outside of the traditional classroom setting. In exchange for hours worked, Amazon interns are paid in accordance with federal, state and local laws and may be eligible for Amazon benefits. Amazon's agreement of employment is with the individual intern and does not extend to third parties. Academic institutions cannot make any commitments to the student on behalf of Amazon. All Amazon interns are expected and required to abide by Amazon policies and procedures throughout the duration of the internship.

All interns will be assigned an onsite manager. The role of this onsite manager is to provide guidance and mentorship throughout the internship program. Interns will also have access to AUTA and line of business HR representatives should any HR related matters arise. All Amazon internships are overseen by the Amazon Intern Program team that is a dedicated resource for both site teams and interns throughout their participation in the program.

Section II. Employee Status

All Amazon internships are paid and are assigned a start and end date. Therefore, all interns are considered temporary employees while in their internship role. While in role, Amazon interns are required to abide by all Amazon employment policies including but not limited to those relating to attendance, social media usage, non-disclosure agreements and employee codes of conduct. Interns may be required to sign additional policy acknowledgments and/or agreements, such as confidentiality and non-disclosure agreements, per Amazon policy and practice. Amazon will provide all necessary Amazon-specific orientation and training.

Any course work required by the institution, such as writing papers or meeting with professors, is at the discretion of the academic institution and the student and not required by Amazon, and therefore is not compensable work time. Any such work must be performed outside of working hours and not utilize Amazon facilities, equipment or confidential information.

Internships are at the will of Amazon and the student. Either Amazon or the student may terminate an internship at any time for any reason. Amazon will make every effort to honor start and end dates, but nothing in this policy alters the at-will nature of the internship employment relationship.

Section III. Internship Privacy Information

A. Employee Privacy

In accordance with Amazon policy, information relating to an intern's employment will be provided directly to the intern. Any confidential intern employment information required by an institution to grant academic credit will need to be provided by the intern.

B. Disciplinary Action/Termination



Human resources matter involves multiple considerations, and we cannot agree to either pre-termination notice or involvement from an outside entity. Amazon has a well-developed structure for performance management and behavioral misconduct. The institution can have the student verify continued employment, and Amazon is also willing to compete continued employment forms as reasonably requested by the intern, but it will remain the intern's obligation to submit.

While we are happy to confirm successful completion of hours and general job duties to an institution designee, we do not provide detailed evaluations or performance feedback to the institution or any third party. Amazon is not in a position to assign letter grades or provide the type of detailed feedback that may be needed to discern between letter grades. Amazon does not determine whether an intern earns credit from an institution. Any information provided by an intern to their academic institution for purposes of requesting academic credit or otherwise may not contain any confidential or proprietary information of Amazon, as set forth in the intern's employee agreement with Amazon.

C. Site Access

The institution's access to the Amazon site at which the intern works will be at the discretion of Amazon and in accordance with applicable policies, including health and safety, security, visitors and confidentiality.

Section IV. Policy Exceptions

This Policy is intended to govern the internship program at Amazon without the need for additional agreements or documentation. Please refer to the section on Internship Performance in this Policy for further clarification on what Amazon will and will not provide to verify successful completion of the internship. If an institution form or other internship verification is required for graduation, it is the student's responsibility to inform Amazon of such requirements prior to beginning the internship and provide a copy of the form and documentation of the requirement. Amazon will consider the request on a case-by-case basis, consistent with its policies. Amazon is not obligated to complete additional forms or verification other than as described in the Internship Performance section of this Policy.



Internship Information (Provided by Amazon):

Intern First Name: Tam	Intern Last Name: Vo
Internship Role: SDE 1	Internship Type: Summer Intern
Program Supervisor: Nikhil Menon	Program Supervisor Title: Sr. Manager, Software Dev, AWS Kinesis Data Streams
Contact Email: nikhim@amazon.com	Contact Phone Number: (206) 310-9395
Internship Start Date: 5/19/2025	Internship End Date: 8/8/2025
Anticipated Hours Per Week: 40 hrs	Anticipated Total Internship Hours: 480 hrs

2025 Software Dev Engineer Summer Intern Job description

Do you want to solve business challenges through innovative technology? Do you enjoy working on cutting-edge, scalable services technology in a team environment? Do you like working on industry-defining projects that move the needle?

At Amazon, we hire the best minds in technology to innovate and build on behalf of our customers. The intense focus we have on our customers is why we are one of the world's most beloved brands – customer obsession is part of our company DNA. Our interns write real software and collaborate with a selected group of experienced software development engineers who help interns on projects that matter to our customers.

We want you to feel welcomed, included and valued right from the start. Every day will be filled with exciting new challenges, developing new skills, and achieving personal growth. How often can you say that your work changes the world? At Amazon, you'll say it often. Join us and define tomorrow.

We have two different internship durations available:

- 3 months internship
- 6 months internship

Please ensure to indicate your availability during the application process.

A day in the life

As an intern, you will be matched to a manager and a mentor. You will have the opportunity to influence the evolution of Amazon technology and lead mission critical projects early in your career. Your design, code, and raw smarts will contribute to solving some of the most complex technical challenges in the areas of distributed systems, data mining, automation, optimisation, scalability, and security – just to name a few.

In addition to working on an impactful project, you will have the opportunity to engage with Amazonians for both personal and professional development, expand your network, and participate in activities with other interns throughout your internship. No matter the location of your internship, we give you the tools to own your project and learn in a real-world setting. Many of our technologies overlap, and you would be hard pressed to find a team that is



not using Amazon Web Services (AWS), touching the catalogue, or iterating services to better personalise for customers. We make the impossible, possible.

Basic qualifications

- Are enrolled in a Bachelor's degree or above in Computer Science, Computer Engineering, or related fields at time of application
- Knowledge of programming languages such as C/C++, Python, Java or Perl
- Knowledge of computer science fundamentals such as object-oriented design, operating systems, algorithms, data structures, and complexity analysis

Preferred qualifications

- Experience from a technical internship
- Experience with distributed, multi-tiered systems, algorithms, and relational databases
- Experience in optimization mathematics such as linear programming and nonlinear optimization
- Ability to effectively articulate technical challenges and solutions
- Adept at handling ambiguous or undefined problems as well as ability to think abstractly

Amazon is an equal opportunities employer. We believe passionately that employing a diverse workforce is central to our success. We make recruiting decisions based on your experience and skills. We value your passion to discover, invent, simplify and build. Protecting your privacy and the security of your data is a longstanding top priority for Amazon. Please consult our Privacy Notice (https://www.amazon.jobs/en/privacy_page) to know more about how we collect, use and transfer the personal data of our candidates.

Amazon is an equal opportunity employer and does not discriminate on the basis of protected veteran status, disability, or other legally protected status.

Our inclusive culture empowers Amazonians to deliver the best results for our customers. If you have a disability and need a workplace accommodation or adjustment during the application and hiring process, including support for the interview or onboarding process, please visit <https://amazon.jobs/content/en/how-we-hire/accommodations> for more information. If the country/region you're applying in isn't listed, please contact your Recruiting Partner.

2025 Software Dev Engineer Summer Intern Key Job Responsibilities

- Collaborate with experienced cross-disciplinary Amazonians to conceive, design, and bring to market innovative products and services.
- Design and build innovative technologies in a large distributed computing environment and help lead fundamental changes in the industry.
- Create solutions to run predictions on distributed systems with exposure to innovative technologies at incredible scale and speed.
- Build distributed storage, index, and query systems that are scalable, fault-tolerant, low cost, and easy to manage/use.
- Work in an agile environment to deliver high quality software.

Manager Signature

Date

08/06/2025

SUPERVISOR EVALUATION OF STUDENT INTERNSHIP

CSC 195/195A CSC 195 CSC 295 N/A

Student Name: Tam Vo Date: 8/6/2025
Organization: California State University, Sacramento
Supervisor Name: Nikhil Menon Phone: (206) 310-9395
Position: Sr. Manager, Software Dev, AWS Kinesis Data Streams
Work period from: 5/19/2025 to: 8/8/2025
Average hours per week: 40 hrs Copy of report received? Yes

The above student has requested college units for the experience gained under your supervision. We would appreciate it if you would rate the student on the following:

Ability to develop a computerized solution to a real life problem using appropriate tools:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Ability to function as a team member:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Effective oral communication:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Effective written communication:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Appropriate use of presentation tools:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Awareness of ethical and societal concerns:

Outstanding	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Weak	Did Not Observe
☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Additional comments (continue on back or attach a separate page if needed):

Thank you for your cooperation.

Nikhil Menon

Supervisor's Signature

Assessment of Academic Internships -- to be completed by Student Academic Intern
Please choose the button that corresponds most closely to your thoughts on the following questions:

At my internship:	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
My supervisor cared about my opinions.	1	2	3	4	5
My supervisor really cared about my well-being.	1	2	3	4	5
My supervisor strongly considered my goals and values.	1	2	3	4	5
My supervisor showed very little concern for me.	1	2	3	4	5

Please choose the button that corresponds most closely to your thoughts on this second set of questions:

The work I did for my internship:	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Was related to the information I learned for my major.	1	2	3	4	5
Was related to a job I hope to get following graduation.	1	2	3	4	5
Met my expectations regarding what I was told would be my tasks and responsibilities.	1	2	3	4	5
Met my expectations regarding what I hoped to learn.	1	2	3	4	5

Again, please choose the button that corresponds most closely to your thoughts on the following questions:

At my internship:	Very False	Moderately False	Slightly False	Neutral	Slightly True	Moderately True	Very True
I felt certain about how much authority I had.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I had clear, planned goals and objectives for my work activities.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I knew that I divided my time properly.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I knew what my responsibilities were.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I knew exactly what was expected of me.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Explanations were clear of what had to be done.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Finally, please respond to the following questions with a few sentences describing your thoughts.

1. What was the most important thing you learned from your Internship experience?

The most important thing I've learned were that the skills required to be a successful software engineer extend far beyond writing code, with the most valuable lessons being the importance of proactive communication and building a community, especially in a modern hybrid work environment.

2. Would you recommend this Internship site to future students? Why or why not?

Yes, I would absolutely recommend this internship site to future students, but with an important caveat. The professional and personal growth I experienced was transformative. The opportunity to work on a service like Kinesis Data Streams, which operates at a scale that is impossible to replicate in an academic setting, is invaluable. It solidified my passion for software engineering, provided me with a full-time job offer, and gave me the confidence that I can contribute to complex, real-world systems. Working at Amazon is prestigious, and the technical skills I gained are directly applicable to my future career.

The primary challenge was not the technical work, but the environmental and social hurdles. Being physically isolated from my entire remote team was incredibly difficult and required a level of proactivity and resilience that I had to learn on the fly. Therefore, I would recommend it to any student who is not just seeking a technical challenge, but who is also prepared to be independent, to actively build their own community, and to take complete ownership of their internship experience. It is an environment where you will be challenged to grow in every respect, but you must be the one to initiate that growth.

3. Is there anything else you'd like to add that your department should know about regarding your Internship experience?

Not much, but thank you for allowing me to collect this internship as college credit!

Student Internship Report: CSC 195

Name: Tam Khai Vo

SAC STATE ID #: 304293665

Email address: khaitamvo@gmail.com

Requesting credit for 3 units of: CSC 195

Semester/Yr: Summer 2025

Organization: Amazon

Supervisor: Nikhil Menon

Position: Summer SDE Intern

Date started: 5/19/2025

Date ended: 8/15/2025

Monthly rate of pay: \$9,590

Hours per week: 40

Internship Narrative

What computer science related tasks did you perform?

During my internship at Amazon, I was Software Development Engineer (SDE) intern on the Kinesis Data Streams team within Amazon Web Services (AWS). My primary project was to design, develop, and deploy and incorporate AI into the CI/CD pipeline which will service critical infrastructure and catch bugs in test environments.

The technical skills expressed within this internship involved capturing continuous feedback, emphasis on documentation, system design, through unit tests, backend development, and agile methodologies.

Communication and feedback channels were leveraged to get customer feedback and get an idea if a feature is worth developing or to move the project in another direction. Early and continuous feedback were emphasized for a successful project.

Amazon's writing culture was the biggest cultural shock to me. People would schedule meetings to read, and this led to the emphasis on documentation. Writing documentation is key to expressing ideas. So, I worked to flesh out a design document for 2 weeks.

An intern's project is supposed to have low ambiguity, but in my case, this wasn't the case, the design document took a huge portion of the internship. A fully fleshed out design document, consists of the problem statement, assumptions, architecture, use cases, and milestones. Getting these timelines and goals fleshed out before working took a while to get a consensus on, but we've made it.

Alongside the design document, there is code. There is a huge emphasis on code ownership and therefore creating unit tests and integration tests are key to create highly maintainable code. Learning the testing framework in Java was one of the biggest hurdles I've faced when I was at Amazon.

Since I was working with Amazon specific code, I had to learn their proprietary code and process of deployment. I learned and utilized Amazon's internal Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) pipelines to deploy my changes to a staging environment and, eventually, to production. This gave me hands-on experience with the operational side of running a large-scale distributed system.

With my internship being 12 weeks, Amazon operated with two-week sprint cycle, participating in semi-daily stand-up, sprint planning, and retrospectives. All my code was submitted for rigorous review by my team, providing an excellent feedback loop.

What is the relationship of the work to your major studies?

My work at Amazon was a direct and practical application of my coursework at Sacramento State. CSC 131 Software Engineering, CSC 130 Data Structures & Object-Oriented Design, and CSC 137 Computer Organization were classes that directly prepared me for this internship. My daily work was centered on writing object-oriented code in Java. A strong understanding of data structures was essential for writing efficient code and for passing the technical interviews required to obtain the internship. CSC 137 provided the foundational knowledge of computer optimizations that was necessary to design and build my project's core component and while abstract, understanding how systems operate at a lower level was beneficial when debugging performance and integration issues in a complex, distributed environment. Finally, the team's agile processes, focus on the software development lifecycle, and emphasis on code reviews were a real-world implementation of the concepts taught in the CSC 131 course.

How interesting and challenging was it?

The experience was interesting and challenged my technical and soft skills. The technical work was had me contributing to the Kinesis Data Streams service used by thousands of internal and external Amazon customers. Understanding the massive scale and complexity of the codebase was an immense, but rewarding, task. However, the most significant challenge was not technical, but environmental. As part of Amazon's "Return to Office" policy, I worked from the Santa Monica campus. But my entire team, including my manager and mentor, was remotely stationed in the Seattle campus. This served as a learning opportunity to connect and work well with remote coworkers. While I was surrounded by people, I felt isolated. Simple questions that could be resolved in a 30-second chat in person required scheduling a video call. The midpoint of my internship was particularly challenging when I encountered a critical integration blocker that was difficult to debug remotely. This feeling of isolation was a constant hurdle that I had to actively work to overcome.

What did you learn from your experience?

I learned that the skills required to be a successful software engineer extend far beyond writing code. Even though I gained proficiency in Java, I learned to write robust and testable code, and became comfortable with enterprise-level development workflows, including CI/CD pipelines and rigorous code reviews. The most valuable lesson was the importance of proactive communication and community building. I learned that in a modern hybrid work environment, you cannot be a passive participant. I had to take ownership of my experience, actively seek out help, and build a network with peers who were physically in the office. For personal growth, I learned resilience. Instead of succumbing to the initial isolation, I forced myself to connect with other interns and engineers outside of my team. This network became an invaluable support system, both for technical advice and for my own well-being.

What were the benefits to you?

The benefits of this internship were transformative for both my personal and professional life. Career wise, this internship solidified my passion for software engineering and gave me a clear vision for my career path. I gained invaluable, real-world experience at a top technology company, working on problems at a scale that cannot be replicated in an academic setting. I built a strong network of peers and mentors who I can connect with throughout my career. I was fortunate to receive a return offer for a full-time SDE position upon graduation, which provides immense peace of mind.

Personally, I emerged with far greater confidence in my ability to communicate, adapt to challenging environments, and take initiative.

What advice would you have for a fellow student and/or faculty member with regard to your experience?

For students, I think the biggest challenge might not be the project, but the environment. Whether you are remote, hybrid, or in-person, take immediate and deliberate action to build your community. Introduce yourself to people. Go to the intern or student events. Find other interns in similar situations. This network will be one of your most valuable resources. Don't wait until you have a problem to ask for help. Be curious and talk to engineers on other teams. Most people are happy to share their experience. The connections you make over a casual coffee chat can become lifesaver when you face a difficult technical blocker. And finally, embrace the uncomfortable. If you feel awkward or isolated, you are not alone. Pushing through that discomfort to introduce yourself or join a group is a skill. The more you do it, the easier it gets.

For faculty, I'd encourage students to understand that their future colleagues are sitting right next to them. Fostering a strong sense of community and peer support within the department can help prepare students for the team-based, network-reliant nature of the modern tech industry. Also to share non-technical stories and not just to share their technical projects, but their non-technical challenges and how they overcame them, would be incredibly valuable for students preparing for their first internship.